

DRAFT - Nomination Java Champion

Anyul Led Rivas Oropeza

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Nominee Profile

Anyul Led Rivas Oropeza is a Senior Architect at GFT with more than twenty years of experience building software and seventeen years working professionally with Java, beginning in 2009. His career has taken him from traditional Java enterprise applications through Spring-based systems, cloud-native platforms, distributed systems and modern Java architectures. Across those years, a consistent theme in his work has been software craftsmanship: testing, refactoring, maintainable design and pragmatic modernization.

Beyond his professional work, Anyul has spent years contributing to the developer community in Barcelona. He has been involved with Barcelona JUG since 2019, first as a volunteer and later as a board member, and with Software Crafters Barcelona since 2021. He has also contributed to JBCNConf and DevBcn, taught Java and software engineering inside companies and in public courses, mentored students and career changers, and volunteered in programs intended to help people enter the technology job market.

His public technical work focuses primarily on Java, software craftsmanship, testing and refactoring, architecture and modernization. He has spoken or taught at Spring I/O, Talent Arena, JMad, DevOxx Belgium, JavaCro, Software Crafters Barcelona and Barcelona JUG, among other events. His open-source contributions include Spring PetClinic, Eclipse JKube and JReleaser.

Java Champions are leaders

Barcelona JUG

Anyul has been an active member of the Barcelona Java community since 2019. He began as a volunteer and later became a Barcelona JUG board member. His responsibilities have included event organization, finding venues, communication with speakers, brainstorming event formats, social media, partnerships, master-of-ceremony duties, recording sessions and publishing them on YouTube. His involvement has remained uninterrupted across changes of employer, from Roche to Ingram Micro and later GFT.

The community has more than 2,500 registered members, around 200 active members, and typical attendance of approximately 30 to 50 people per meetup. Anyul has organized or co-organized all 41 Barcelona JUG activities recorded in his public trajectory, covering topics such as Java releases, Spring Boot, Quarkus, GraalVM, Testcontainers, OpenTelemetry, mutation testing, property-based testing, reactive Java, architecture and software craftsmanship. He also helped energize the community after the pandemic and bring new participants into a regular cadence of activities.

Notable speakers brought to the community during this period include Victor Rentea, Alex Soto, Horacio Gonzalez, Christian Tzolov, Grzegorz Piwowarek, Dmitry Chuyko, Philip Krenn, Edú Melendez, Joris Kuipers, Sergio del Amo, Andres Almiray, Max Rydahl Andersen, Ivan Badía and Jorge Hidalgo.

Representative links:

- [Barcelona JUG](#)
- [Java 25 meetup](#)
- [Testing with Spring Boot & microservices](#)
- [Spring Modulith workshop](#)
- [Quarkus Tour meetup](#)

JBCNConf and DevBcn

Anyul started volunteering for JBCNConf after the 2019 edition. When the conference returned in 2021 after the pandemic interruption, he volunteered and served as a track moderator. From 2022 onward he has participated in every edition of DevBcn, the successor conference, contributing to both community operations and digital infrastructure.

His work has included maintaining the ticketing platform, configuring the CFP website, website design, social media, the Mailchimp newsletter, merchandising and printed material, sponsor-lead exports, the attendee feedback platform, photography coverage for speakers and the event, and publication of recorded sessions on YouTube. Recent editions have reached approximately 1,200 attendees.

- [DevBcn](#)
- [JBCNConf 2022](#)
- [JBCNConf 2021](#)

Software Crafters Barcelona

Since 2021, Anyul has also contributed to Software Crafters Barcelona, first as a volunteer and later as a board member. He helps organize the annual conference, find sponsors, participate in the CFP committee, and design community activities. More importantly, he personally organizes and facilitates coding dojos, many of them using Java, centered on TDD, refactoring, functional programming and architectural design.

His public trajectory records 23 Software Crafters Barcelona activities, including repeated refactoring and TDD katas, Global Day of Code Retreat events, architecture katas and the annual Software Crafters conference. This work complements his Java community activity by creating a regular place where developers can practice techniques rather than only hear about them.

- [Software Crafters Barcelona](#)
- [TDD Kata](#)
- [Architecture Kata](#)

Java Champions are technical luminaries

Anyul has worked professionally with Java since 2009. His experience spans Java 6, 8, 11, 17 and 21 as well as long-lived systems that required migration from older Java versions. His technical work has included Spring and Spring Boot, Maven and Gradle, JUnit, AssertJ, Mockito, Testcontainers, ArchUnit, contract testing, Hibernate/JPA, reactive Java, Kafka, OpenTelemetry, OpenFeature, Quarkus and cloud-native deployment patterns.

His technical identity is centered on three areas: software craftsmanship; testing and refactoring; and architecture and Java modernization. He has applied those areas in production environments and also taught them repeatedly to other developers.

Architecture and Java modernization

Across his professional career, Anyul has worked on several generations of Java systems. At Venezolano de Crédito he participated in migrating internal applications from Java 1.4 to Java 8 and from OC4J to WebLogic. At GFT he worked with Java 8, Spring Boot and Spring Cloud on distributed systems. At Roche he worked with Java 8 and 11 on Spring Boot and Kubernetes applications and designed an automated Maven-based solution to sign and verify Java artifacts. At Ingram Micro he worked as Principal Software Engineer with Java 17, Spring Boot, Quarkus, OpenFeature, OpenTelemetry and Testcontainers. In his current role at GFT he works with Java 21, Maven, JSpecify, OpenRewrite, PMD, Kafka, JPA and Testcontainers on modernization initiatives.

He has also publicly advocated pragmatic architectural modernization. At Spring I/O 2024 he co-delivered a workshop on transitioning from a monolithic architecture to Spring Modulith. This reflected a position he had

already been promoting in practice: modular monoliths can be a better architectural choice than prematurely adopting microservices, particularly when team and domain boundaries do not justify distributed-system complexity.

- [Spring I/O 2024 - Transitioning from monolithic architecture to Spring Modulith](#)

Advanced Java teaching artifacts

As an Advanced Java instructor at arol.dev, Anyul developed and taught hands-on material supported by a set of public Java repositories. The material covers clean architecture and refactoring, service decomposition, saga patterns, synchronous communication, API versioning, distributed transactions and integration testing with Testcontainers. These repositories make the technical content of the course directly inspectable and reusable beyond the classroom.

- [arol.dev - Java Avanzado: clean architecture and refactoring](#)
- [arol.dev - Java Avanzado: saga patterns](#)
- [arol.dev - Java Avanzado: distributed transactions](#)
- [arol.dev - Java Avanzado: Testcontainers](#)

Open-source contributions

Anyul has made focused contributions to several Java ecosystem projects, particularly where they overlap with his interest in testing, refactoring and developer tooling:

- Spring PetClinic: in 2024 he authored twelve commits focused primarily on improving the test suite, including clearer and more consistent AssertJ assertions, removal of redundant assertions and general test-code refactoring.
- Eclipse JKube: his merged PR #575 refactored map-handling logic across several modules to use standard Java Map.putIfAbsent and computeIfAbsent APIs, removing redundant utility code and simplifying the implementation.
- JReleaser: as an early adopter and contributor, he added Google Chat support to the announcement functionality and later contributed the Catalan translation. Project lead Andres Almiray publicly highlighted Anyul as an exemplary contributor during a community presentation.
- [Spring PetClinic commits by anyulled](#)
- [Eclipse JKube PR #575](#)
- [JReleaser commits by anyulled](#)
- [Andres Almiray highlighting the JReleaser contribution](#)

Java Champions are independent-minded and credible

Anyul's community work is independent of his employers. His participation in Barcelona JUG and Software Crafters Barcelona has continued uninterrupted while he worked at Roche, Ingram Micro and GFT, and the communities themselves are deliberately vendor-neutral.

As a Barcelona JUG organizer, he works to keep the program useful to developers rather than aligned with a sponsor or product. The community has hosted content covering competing technologies and approaches, including both Spring and Quarkus, and sponsors do not control the editorial program. In one Quarkus-focused meetup, the community also included a talk from its own developer team providing an honest comparison between Spring and Quarkus rather than treating the event as product promotion.

The same approach appears in Anyul's own speaking. He generally focuses on practices and techniques rather than product presentations. His advocacy of modular monoliths, including the Spring Modulith workshop at Spring I/O, is an example of challenging the then-dominant assumption that microservices were the default modernization destination. His software-craftsmanship work similarly emphasizes testability, feedback, refactoring and maintainability rather than attachment to a particular vendor stack.

- [Barcelona JUG Quarkus Tour](#)
- [Spring I/O Spring Modulith workshop](#)

Java Champions are involved with cool applications of Java technology, humanitarian efforts, or educational programs

Teaching developers and students

Education has been a recurring part of Anyul's work. At GFT, over several years, he regularly delivered internal Java training to groups of approximately 10 to 20 developers, with particular emphasis on Java 8, lambdas, streams, testing and refactoring. At Ingram Micro he facilitated monthly coding dojos throughout his four years there, centered on TDD and refactoring.

In 2025 he taught two cohorts of an Advanced Java course at arol.dev, with approximately ten students per cohort. He delivered Java-based sessions covering distributed-system patterns, performance testing and asynchronous communication with Kafka and RabbitMQ, and prepared supporting videos and a set of public hands-on repositories for students. Those repositories cover clean architecture and refactoring, service decomposition, saga patterns, synchronous communication, API versioning, distributed transactions and Testcontainers, providing reusable exercises and examples that remain publicly available after the course.

- [arol.dev GitHub organization](#)
- [Advanced Java - saga lab](#)
- [Advanced Java - distributed transactions](#)
- [Advanced Java - Testcontainers](#)

He has also participated in university outreach. In 2021 he delivered a TDD masterclass at La Salle University, and he has participated in fishbowl-style events at UPC intended to help students understand how to enter the IT job market.

- [La Salle TDD masterclass evidence](#)

Migracode and employability programs

Since 2022, Anyul has been a main instructor with Migracode, helping expatriates and people seeking access to the technology sector. He has taught three cohorts of approximately 30 students each, primarily covering programming fundamentals and cloud computing with AWS. Approximately 40% of the roughly 90 students across those cohorts subsequently entered IT-related employment.

This work is complemented by other volunteer initiatives. He served as a Java mentor at HackUPC from 2017 through 2023, volunteered with Barcelona Activa's Mentoring+ program to help unemployed people prepare for jobs in technology, mentored full-stack teams at Jump2Digital, and volunteered for 36 hours at UPC/TV3's bitsXlaMarato initiative supporting a mental-health cause.

- [Migracode](#)
- [AWS re/Start / Migracode evidence](#)
- [HackUPC](#)
- [Barcelona Activa](#)
- [Jump2Digital](#)

Java Champions are able to evangelize or influence other developers

Anyul has shared Java, architecture and software-craftsmanship practices through public talks, workshops, panels, coding dojos and community events. His public trajectory currently records eighteen speaking or teaching appearances from 2021 through 2026, in addition to the events he organizes for Barcelona JUG and Software Crafters Barcelona.

Representative Java and JVM-related appearances include:

- DevOxx Belgium 2026 - From vibe coding to harness engineering: modernizing a regulated environment with AI.
- JavaCRO 2026 - Why We Cling to Chaos: A Sociotechnical Exploration of Accidental Complexity in Engineering Teams.
- Software Crafters Barcelona 2026 - Harness engineering.
- JMad 2026 - Harness Engineering.

- MWC Upskilling Week 2026 - practical workshop on Java, Spring and Spring AI.
- Talent Arena 2026 - Java/Spring/Spring AI workshop and an Ask Me Anything about Java.
- Talent Arena 2025 - Java, Spring and Spring AI workshop.
- Spring I/O 2024 - co-speaker for a Spring Modulith workshop.
- Barcelona JUG - Java 25, architecture, testing and other community sessions.
- [Devoxx Belgium 2026 speaker page](#)
- [JavaCro 2026 speakers](#)
- [JMad](#)
- [Talent Arena 2025](#)
- [MWC Upskilling Week](#)

The lasting impact of this work is not limited to individual talks. Anyul has helped build a regular cadence for Barcelona JUG and brought new people into the community who now participate as active and enthusiastic members. The community continues independently of any one employer or event. That combination of sustained organization, technical teaching and practical knowledge sharing is the central thread of his contribution to the Java ecosystem.